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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Winnie's World gets rave reviews!



Learning Outcome

Describe the reasons or results of events or actions in spoken or written texts, in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Did you have a favorite book when you were a child? Which one?
- What makes a great children's book?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about the present results of something in the past.
- I can write about the purpose of events or actions.
- I can write a review.





Let's Explore!

Some are giving Winnie's World **rave reviews***. Will you be ordering a copy this Christmas season?

* "Rave reviews" are positive assessments of a work given in a very enthusiastic way.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

When I went for a neighborhood stroll with a publisher friend of mine, she handed me a copy of the delightfully engaging *Winnie's World* to take home and enjoy. I couldn't resist publishing a review online about my reactions to the children's book that very evening. Since there has been a lot of talk of late about sadness, conflict and negativity related to social media, a book about hugs and connecting with others seems like a perfect subject to read during the holiday season. Winnie and Wally are the very best of friends. They love to play in the park together, make yummy cakes together and even go on holidays with their families together. However, there is one thing that these little hedgehogs can't do and that is hug each other because of their pesky prickles. Since the beginning of their friendship they have tried all sorts of solutions. Yet, no matter what they try, their prickly problem has remained. They have even considered wrapping themselves in tissue paper until their long lost relative has a solution!

Written and illustrated by Canadian husband and wife team Marisa Mitchell (author) and Ronald Atkins (illustrator), *Winnie's World* is a charming picture book, ideal for bedtime. It's excellent for encouraging conversations about family, friendship, sharing and patience. It is also ideal for providing an introductory explanation of different personalities and the sharing of personal information over the Internet.

Atkin's illustrations are simply breathtaking. Children and adults alike are in for a visual treat. He offers the reader images that leap from the page and incredible attention to detail. The text is simple, talking about all the things Winnie and Wally do together, as well as their attempts to safely give each other a friendly hug. Since the official release of *Winnie's World* has not yet happened, it is a good idea to place orders now. It is the perfect book for the holiday season and to slip into a Christmas stocking. It's also great for reading as you could cuddle up with your child during the festive season. This children's book is the most recent offering by BFP Publishing and solidifies their position in providing high-quality literature to their readership. Look out for it in early December.



Let's Practice!

Some things never change.

Instructions: Choose the option that best completes the sentences.

1. Since there _____ a lot of talk about sadness and conflict, a book about hugs seems like a perfect subject to read during the holiday season.
2. Since the beginning of their friendship they _____ all sorts of solutions.
3. Yet, no matter what they try, their prickly problem _____.
4. Since the official release of _____ has not yet happened, it is a good idea to place orders now.
5. With all the challenges we _____ this year, we can smile when we read a delightful tale of family and friendship.

has tried	has been	has happened
have tried		has be
have faced	has remained	Winnie's World



Let's Practice!

The reviewer reflects on her impressions of the book.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Write each word in the correct order. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. delightfully engaging, / she handed me / with a publisher / a copy of the / Winni's world. / When I went / for neighborhood stroll / friend of mine,
2. encouraging / friendship. / excellent / conversations / about / It's / for
3. visual / and / adults /are in / for a / treat./ Children / alike
4. also ideal / for providing / It is /an opportunity / sharing information / over the / Internet. / to talk about
5. you cuddle up / reading as / It's also / great for / with your / season. / child during / the festive





Extension Activity

Your friend needs help writing a book review for his employer.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Write a 12-14 line dialogue between you and a friend about what he/she needs to include in a book review.
- Describe the structure of a book review.
- Talk about characters, setting and plot.
- Explain to your friend the need to express his opinion.
- Suggest that he needs to say if he recommends the book or not.
- When completed, read the dialogue aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue about book reviews.

☐ ☐

I write about characters, setting and plots.

☐ ☐

I write about expressing an opinion.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to cuddle** (verb): to hold someone in your arms in order to show affection
e.g. It's also great for reading as you cuddle up with your toddler during the festive season.
- **treat** (noun): something pleasant or amusing that is unusual or unexpected
e.g. He offers the reader a visual treat with images that leap from the page and his incredible attention to detail.
- **prickle** (noun): one of usually many stiff, sharp points
e.g. However, there is one thing that these little hedgehogs can't do and that is hug each other because of their pesky prickles.
- **to wrap** (verb): to cover something by winding or folding a piece of material around it
e.g. They have even considered wrapping themselves in tissue paper!
- **offering** (noun): something that is available for sale or use
e.g. This children's book is the most recent offering by BFP Publishing.
- **Christmas stocking** (noun): a long sock used to hold small presents at Christmas
e.g. It is the perfect book for the holiday season and to slip into a Christmas stocking.
- **illustrator** (noun): a person who draws pictures for books
e.g. He is a fantastic illustrator.





Learning Points

Present Perfect When Commenting on the Present Results of Something in the Past

You use the **Present Perfect** to talk about past actions that have a connection to the present.

When you want to comment on the present results of a past action you can use the **Present Perfect** with verbs like *appear*, *seem* and *sound*.

For example:

It sounds as if you've already decided on the next course of action.
It seems they have completed the report ahead of schedule.

The form of the **Present Perfect** is:

subject + has/have + past participle

You can use *since* and *yet* to introduce the past event.

For example:

- **Since** the beginning of their friendship, they have tried all sorts of solutions.
- **Yet**, no matter what they try, their prickly problem has remained.

Examples:

- *Since there has been a lot of talk of late about sadness and conflict, a book about hugs seems like a perfect subject to read during the holiday season.*





Learning Points

How to write a review of a book

When you write a review of a book, you are offering a combination of summary and commentary on what you have read.
You are also trying to persuade the reader.

Book reviews are written in formal language and in paragraphs.

Here are the general elements of a book review:

Introduction

You need to provide basic information about the book:

- Title and the author
- Publication Information
- Genre
- A brief introduction to the book and the review

Body

Provide brief descriptions of the setting and other major characters.

Explain the plot.

How would you describe the writing style?

Are there images or illustrations? How do they connect to the text?

Be careful not to give away important plot details or the ending.

You can write about your own opinions.

Would you recommend it to others? Why or why not?

Conclusion

Briefly conclude by pulling your thoughts together. You may want to say what impression the book left you with, or emphasize what you want your reader to know about it.

